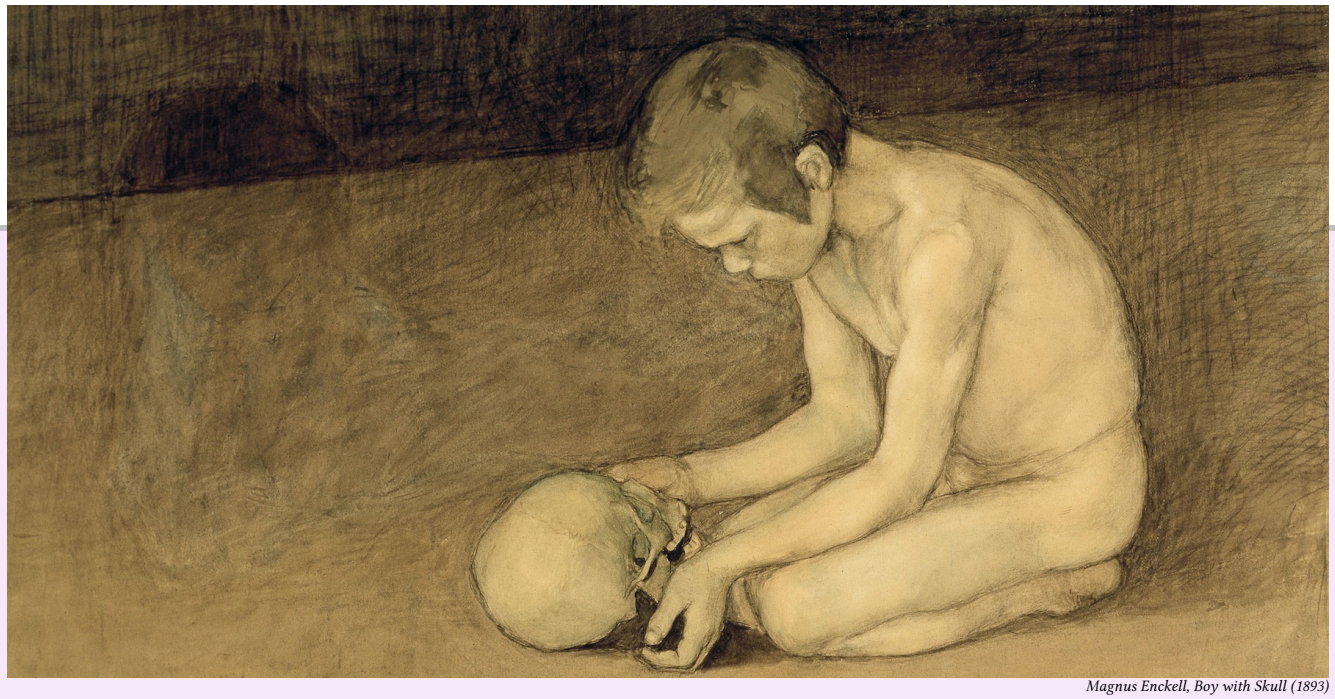
PHI251
Visions of the Self



Magnus Enckell, Boy with Skull (1893)

Self, Self-Awareness, Self-Conception

Know thyself: this was the maxim inscribed on the temple of Apollo in Delphi, in Ancient Greece, and it is also the goal of this class. We will explore a range of philosphical positions on the nature of the self, the ways in which the self is aware of itself, and the relation between the self and how it thinks about itself.

David Sanson
Spring 2027

MW 3:35–4:50pm
Stevenson 230

MW 5:00–6:15pm
Stevenson 230

- self, soul, mind, body, human animal, person
- "I think therefore I am"
- the Buddhist doctrine of no-self (anattā)
- death and immortality
- the narrative conception of the self
- awareness of oneself and awareness of others
- the unity of consciousness
- the self as agent: desires, values, and free will
- being bored with oneself

Prerequisites. none.

www.davidsanson.com/251s2027